the equator and stretches those near the poles. This is why countries like Norway and Sweden look much larger than they are in reality while India and Indonesia look much smaller.

It was with Mercator's encouragement that Ortilius produced the first atlas in 1570 in Antwerp. The first edition of the atlas had seventy sheets and was called the *Theatrum Orbis Terrarum* (Theatre of the World). It proved such a success that forty editions would eventually be published. It is interesting to see how the rediscovery of classical Greek and Roman works had a profound impact on the European mind of that time. Ortelius took pains to include a map that tried to reconcile the new findings about India with the *Periplus* and with Arrian's account of Alexander's expedition. The map identifies the location of cities like Pataliputra and Muzaris with surprising accuracy given the passage of time. In a sense, it was the first attempt to recreate the history of India's geography and is consequently a direct ancestor of this book.

THE CITY OF VICTORY

One of the most prominent features of early European maps of India is the kingdom of 'Narsinga' that covers much of the southern peninsula. Most modern Indians will have difficulty identifying this name because it refers to what is now remembered as the Vijayanagar empire, named after its capital city. It was ruled by Narasingha Raya when the Portuguese first arrived in India. He was not an especially important monarch in the history of Vijayanagar, but his name stuck and Europeans continued to mark it on their maps long after he and his empire were gone.

The city of Vijayanagar was established just after the devastating raids of Alauddin Khilji's general Malik Kafur had broken down the old power structures of southern India. Around 1336, two brothers, Hukka and Bukka, appear to have rallied various defeated groups under their banner and built a fortified new city called Vijayanagar or City of Victory. At its height in the early sixteenth century it was probably the largest city in the world.